



Syllabus- CSA 20: Computer Information Systems Applications



Unlock Your Inner Tech Superpowers!

Prof

Meet Your Guide: Professor Information

Professor: Tony Pacheco

Office: SCMA 137

Office Hours: Mon./Wed. 8:00 to 8:50 am, Tues. 8:15 to 12:15 or other days/time by appointment. 📧 Contact via Canvas message or email.

Email: ProfessorTony77@gmail.com 📧 Or use Canvas message.

Preferred Contact Method: Canvas messaging is usually best for quick questions!

Fun Fact: Hey future tech wizards! I'm excited to help you start your C.S. adventure. When I'm not teaching, you can find me on the track, running/training, or online finding some good tech videos or movies! 🏃🏻‍♂️ 🎬 🎧



CSA20

Course: Information

Course: Computer Information Systems Applications: 3 Units

Term: 2026, Sections: #72070 (SCMA 355, MoWe 2:00PM - 3:20PM)

Hosted via Canvas at: sjdc.instructure.com 🔗

Final Exam: Week of Dec. 7th, 2026 📅

Preferred Contact Method: Canvas email is the best form of immediate contact as phone messages are not checked often.

INFO

Course Description: Your Mission, Should You Choose to Accept It...

Welcome to **Computer Information Systems Applications**! Ever wonder how to do something in one of your favorite apps? Ready to level up your digital literacy? Join us in CSA 20 as we dive into the core applications of the PC world. You will gain hands-on experience navigating the Windows environment, exploring the web with confidence, and mastering the "Big Three" of productivity: Microsoft Word, Excel, and PowerPoint. Whether you are a beginner or looking to sharpen your existing skills, this course transforms how you interact with technology. You'll be surprised at what you can learn! 🖥️

Official- Course Description:

This course is designed to introduce the student to a microcomputer and the PC based programs such as Internet Explorer, Windows Operating System, Microsoft Word (word processor), Excel(spreadsheet), and PowerPoint (presentation graphics). (CSU)

AIM

Course Objectives

Upon successful completion of this course, the student will be able to:

- Demonstrate the use of the word processor Microsoft Word.
- Develop electronic spreadsheets and generate charts using Microsoft Excel.
- Create a presentation using Microsoft PowerPoint.
- Demonstrate file management techniques with a Windows Operating System.
- Use basic browser techniques to search through Web pages.
- Use a communication tool such as e-mail to send and receive messages.

SKILL



Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, the student will be able to:

- Students will be able to construct a newsletter.
- Students will use the Mail Merge Wizard to produce a set of mailing labels for a newsletter.



CAL

Key Dates - Mark Your Calendars!

Spring SESSION DATES: (Download PDF for all Spring sessions/dates)- [CLICK HERE!](#) 🔗

• **Start Date (Aug. 14):** Late Start Day, of Spring Semester. - Let the Adventure Begin! 🚀

• **Drop w/Refund (Aug. 28):** Last day to Drop with Full Refund! 📅

• **Drop w/No 'W' (Aug. 28):** Last day to Drop with NO 'W' AND last day to Add. 📅

• **Drop w/'W' (Oct. 13):** Last day to Drop with a 'W' 📅

• **Finals Week (Dec. 7):** Final Exams Week thru Dec. 11 - The Grand Finale! 🎉

• (Always check Canvas Course dashboard and Online Calendar for other important dates and holidays)

GEAR

REQUIRED Text & Items - Your Toolkit! **IMPORTANT**

- **e-Textbook (Online, E-Text and MyLab online access):** Evans, MyLab IT with Pearson eText Access Code for GO! 2025 with Technology in Action, 18e ISBN 9780135896495.

Note: We'll be using this extensively. You can find it at the campus bookstore. Obtain this ASAP. Assignments due, use the online content!

- **Software / Other Online Access:** TryHackMe site. LinkedIn Learning. <https://onecompiler.com/python>, Office 365.

Good news! This software is free and we'll walk through how to install it.

- **Hardware: *Very Important***

- A reliable computer (Windows - Required), assignments will Require use of a Windows PC. Administrator access suggested. 🖥️
- Reliable Internet access for online assignments, quizzes, and exams. 🌐
- A USB flash drive for Labs & backing up your work, suggested. (Minimum 512GB!). 💾

- **Other:** Access to the college's Learning Management System (LMS) – Canvas! All announcements, assignments, links, and grades will be posted there! 🌐

RULES

Course Policies & Procedures - The Game Rules!

Attendance & Participation: Your Journey, Your Presence!

Attendance every week is IMPORTANT, **your presence is crucial** Lectures, discussions, and activities are designed to help you succeed. Think of it like leveling up in a game – you can't get experience points if you're not playing! Active participation will also count towards your grade. In addition to Attendance, online assignments, discussions, labs, and tests are how your grade is determined. **It is your responsibility** to get all the work done! If you have any questions, PLEASE ASK. I am here to facilitate your success. Check Canvas often, participate, read announcements, and do the assignments. You can do it! ****During the first week of the course there will be 3 check-in assignments due! ** CRUCIAL to avoid being DROPPED!**

Late Work: Beat the Clock!

Assignments have due dates for a reason – they help you stay on track and build knowledge sequentially. Assignments submitted late will have a penalty. Again, you are responsible for doing the work and doing it on time! Late penalty will be 1% of assignment score per day, maximum 10% penalty. (Example: 3 days late = 3% penalty, deduction from assignment score). *Pro Tip: Aim to finish early! You'll thank yourself later.*

Make-Up Exams & Emergency Policy: Life Happens!

Make-up exams will only be granted for **verifiable, documented emergencies** (e.g., serious illness with a doctor's note, family emergency). You must contact me **as soon as possible**, preferably before the exam, to discuss arrangements. The same applies to extensions for major assignments under emergency circumstances.

Academic Integrity: Code with Honor!

This is a big one! All work submitted in this course must be **your own original work**, unless explicitly stated otherwise. **What's Okay:** Discussing concepts, getting help understanding errors. **What's NOT Okay:** Copying written work or code, sharing completed assignments, having someone else do your work. Any instance of academic dishonesty will result in a **zero for the assignment/exam**, and may be reported to the college. Let's keep it honest! Tools such as Turnitin may be used to check for similarities.

Classroom/Online Conduct, Tutors, and Individual Assistance: Respect is Key!

Our classroom, Online or In Person, is a learning community. Be respectful. Conduct should fit a classroom/learning environment. Be considerate of others. Do not argue, though questioning and presenting of ideas with supportive reasoning is encouraged. In the classroom, silence cell phones. Laptops for notes/exercises only. Ask questions! If you have questions about tutoring, check Delta Online Tutoring/NetTutor at this online link [CLICK HERE!](#) 🔗 You may also consider working with a study group or post a question in the Canvas course discussion board. Post general questions, comments, requests to form study groups, links to interesting articles or websites, or any course related information. Posts that are deemed inappropriate by the professor will be deleted and may result in student discipline. Other students are often quite helpful and will generally provide a lot of support. And, of course, you can always ask the Professor- in an online Canvas message!

Communication: Stay Connected!

Always Check Canvas for announcements. *Your professor may not have time to respond to all individual communications. If there are areas of general misunderstanding or errors, the problem may be addressed as an Announcement item or other mass communication method. Please understand that there are over 200 students enrolled in courses taught by your professor, which places a very heavy demand on your professor and as a result there may be little flexibility in handling of individual requests. Canvas email for private communications will be checked on a regular basis and is the best form of direct, private communication with your professor. *Office hours are best for detailed help!

INF

Assistance and Other Important Online Student Information!

Delta maintains a College Website with Links to important student information including the current Student Handbook. [CLICK HERE!](#) 🔗

- **Need Assistance?** Students requiring accommodations for a certified disability that may affect class performance are requested to contact me during the first week of the semester. You can also meet with a staff member at Disability Support Programs and Services (DSPS) so that appropriate arrangements can be made. DSPS is located in the DeRicco Building, 2nd floor. The phone number is (209) 954-5151 x6272

- **Student Services:** Extensive online page with Student services, programs, financial aid information, and other resources for all students! [CLICK HERE!](#)

- **CANVAS Access:** To access your classes, course, online resources, L.M.S., and Fully Online courses you need to log into the college online learning tool CANVAS, through your MyDelta Dashboard. For, How to Login to CANVAS?, [CLICK HERE!](#) 📌

- **Drops?** "DROPS" ARE THE RESPONSIBILITY OF THE STUDENT. 📅 Except for the first 2 weeks of the term. Students may be dropped for "non-attendance". **The professor reserves the right to make any adjustments in the operation of this course that in professional judgment are warranted to better meet the needs of the students and the objectives of the course.**

GRADE

Grading Policy - How You'll Level Up!

Students will be evaluated by a final examination and, at the professor's discretion, one or more of the following: midterms, quizzes, homework, computer programs, discussions, and/or class activities.

Grade Breakdown:

- Assignments (Questions, Labs & Problems): 32%
- Quizzes (In-class or Online): 34%
- Midterm Exam: 14%
- Final Exam (Cumulative): 17%
- Participation & In-Class Activities: 3%

Grading Scale:

A: 90-100%

B: 80-89%

C: 70-79%

D: 60-69%

F: Below 60%

Level Up Your Skills!

MAP

Course Schedule - Your Roadmap to Success!

***CANVAS-** Modules is the place to find all assignments! Be sure to start there and work to complete each Module's assignments by the noted Due Dates. Schedule Link below opens a high-level overview of dates, topics, and chapters. T.I.A is the Tech in Action e-Text. Other e-Text, such as GO! Word and GO! Excel, are easily found at the related Pearson Links.

[Click HERE!](#) for assignments full list overview- pdf. Be advised this schedule is subject to change with notice. Check [CANVAS!](#) for the latest updates!

Assignments table (A brief overview of the first 3 chapters).

Ch.	Assignment Name	Category
0	Grader Activity Tutorial	🟢 Homework
0	Simulation Activity Tutorial	🟢 Homework
AI	AI Literacy: Evaluating AI (Credly)	🟢 Homework
AI	AI Literacy: Understanding AI (Credly)	🟢 Homework
TIAa	Chapter Appendix A DSM: The History of the Personal Computer	🟢 Homework
TIA13	Chapter 13 DSM: Behind the Scenes: How the Internet Works	🟢 Homework
TIA13	Chapter 13 Helpdesk: Keeping E-Mail Secure	🟢 Homework
TIA13	Chapter 13 Helpdesk: Understanding IP Addresses, Domain Names, and Protocols	🟢 Homework
TIA13	Chapter 13 Technology Mini Sim: Communicating and Sharing on the Web	🟢 Homework
TIA13	Chapter 13: End-of-Chapter Quiz	🟡 Quiz
TIA5	Chapter 5 DSM: System Software: The Operating System, Utility Programs, and File Management	🟢 Homework
TIA5	Chapter 5 Helpdesk: Organizing Your Computer: File Management	🟢 Homework
TIA5	Chapter 5 Sound Byte: Using Windows Task Manager to Evaluate System Performance	🟢 Homework
TIA5	Chapter 5 Technology Mini Sim: File Management	🟢 Homework
TIA5	Chapter 5 Technology Mini Sim: System Software	🟢 Homework
TIA5	Chapter 5: End-of-Chapter Quiz	🟡 Quiz

QUEST

Assignments - Additional information and Python Coding!

- **Projects:** Such as **Project 1 (Word)**, **Project 1 (Excel)**, **Project 2 (Excel)**, ect. are: exercises to work through in the Pearson online MyLab IT. These exercises are to increase your ability to use each of the Microsoft Office Apps. Word, Excel , and PowerPoint. Expect to spend some time reading through the related chapters for each app and then working through the **Labs/Projects**. ✨

- **You will need to use Office365 apps. Be sure you have access to the Office 365 suite.** Working in / using the Word, Excel, and Powerpoint apps is part of the course and assignments. **Office 365 Online** You will need to get through various assignments during the course that use Office apps. Quiz work will also use Office apps. **Using Office 365 Apps.** Is a large part of the course. 😊

- **Quizzes:** Will cover Chapter material for each Module and chapter reading from T.I.A. Keep those neurons firing! ⚡

- **Midterm & Final Exams:** Will assess your understanding of concepts and your ability to apply them. They will include multiple-choice, short answer, and some coding questions. 📝

- **(Optional) Final Project:** [An Extra Credit Project may be announced prior to the Midterm. "The project, if announced, will be designed to use one or more of the office apps. More details will be provided separately, if a project is announced. 🔗

Code Your Destiny!

A Final Byte of Wisdom...

Learning computer applications is like learning a new language and a new way of thinking. It takes practice, persistence (appropriately!), and patience. Don't be afraid to make mistakes – they are part of the learning process! Ask for help when you need it, collaborate (appropriately!), and most importantly, have fun exploring what you can create! I'm here to help you succeed. Let's have an amazing semester! ✨